

Tanks of the Nonaligned World

Many nations attempted to steer between the two Cold War powers. Some, such as Yugoslavia in the 1950s, purchased equipment from both sides; others, such as the Swiss, continued designing and building their own weapons. Many countries purchased Western tanks, using them for decades and upgrading them with their own systems.



Variety of Sherman hulls converted

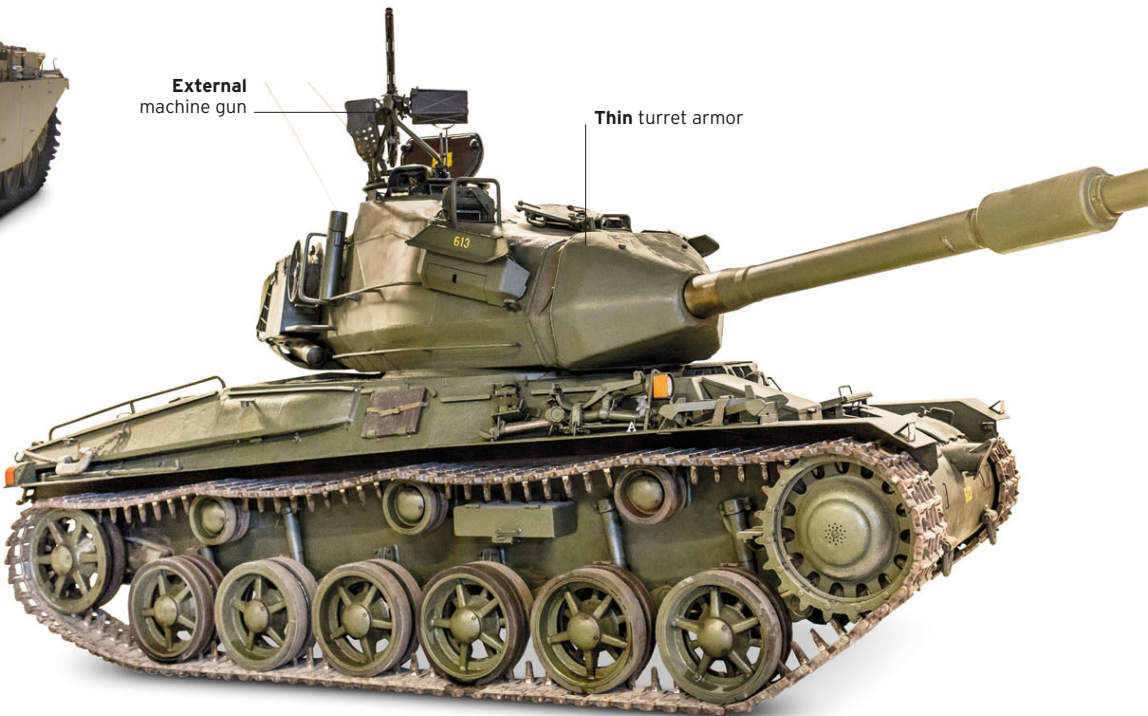
◁	Sherman M-50
Date	1956
Country	Israel
Weight	37.5 tons (34 tonnes)
Engine	Cummins V8 diesel, 460 hp
Main armament	75 mm CN75-50 rifled gun

Developed to keep around 300 older Israeli M4 Shermans viable, the M-50 was equipped with a more powerful engine, HVSS suspension, and the French 75 mm gun also used on the AMX-13. It saw service in the Six Day War of 1967.



△	Sho't
Date	1958
Country	Israel
Weight	57.1 tons (51.8 tonnes)
Engine	Continental AVDS-1790-2A diesel, 750 hp
Main armament	105 mm L7 L/52 rifled gun

At first, the Centurion was unpopular in Israel, with poor reliability. Upgrades including a diesel engine and improved crew training soon changed this perception. Its combat record in 1967 and 1973 proved stellar, especially the defense of the Golan Heights in 1973.



External machine gun

Thin turret armor

▷	Strv 74
Date	1958
Country	Sweden
Weight	24.8 tons (22.5 tonnes)
Engine	2 x Scania-Vabis 603/1 diesels, 170 hp each
Main armament	75 mm Strv 74 rifled gun

The Strv 74 was an upgrade of the 1940s vintage m/42; the most obvious difference was the new, more powerful gun in a large but thinly armored turret. The 225 conversions supplemented the Centurion in Swedish tank units until the late 1960s.



105 mm rifled gun

Commander's cupola

Muzzle brake

Barrel clamp

Towing hitch

◁	Type 61
Date	1961
Country	Japan
Weight	38.5 tons (35 tonnes)
Engine	Mitsubishi 12HM21WT diesel, 570 hp
Armament Main	90 mm L/52 rifled gun

The first post-World War II Japanese tank, the Type 61 was developed instead of buying American vehicles, since they were assessed as being too large and heavy for the Japanese crewmen and the country's geography. A total of 560 were built. None were exported and it never saw combat.